time spent in jail that could offer opportunities to prisoners to at least have options of converting themselves to following a non-criminal life and way of thinking. For the innumerable number of prisoners who spent time without ever being convicted (and their number was absolutely disproportional to the ones who were), mismanagement of this time could criminalize them. It was, therefore, imperative that nothing be permitted that could directly or through induction corrupt and criminalize this large population of prison inmates.

Substance abuse, or drug abuse, was discovered to be convincingly instrumental in leading individuals down the criminal path. It could do so by removing self-restraining inhibitions, by creating aberrations in thinking and functional skills, or by compelling the individual to take to crime to maintain the habit. In the new order of prison reforms such abuse, if permitted to exist because of an inability to control it, would at the outset itself have undone any correctional attempts on the part of the management. The environment in a prison was (and is) a controlled one which, therefore, with sensitivity and sincerity of effort, could become conducive to an anti-substance abuse programme. This feat had been very effectively and tellingly achieved in Tihar.

* * *

A major portion of the prisoners, at least in Indian jails, come from the economically deprived sections of society. These people normally do not possess any skills and, therefore, are unable to make a place for themselves in society. These are the persons who are the most prone to acquiring negative and criminal attitudes if the time spent by them in prison were not managed properly. Imparting of education and self-improvement skills to them should, therefore, stand out as a high-priority effort in prison administration. When there is so much human resource material in a controlled environment, then efforts made towards counselling and directing of their energies towards constructive and creative directions should invariably prove fruitful.

Catering to creature comforts and acquiring of material skills alone would not be sufficient. Efforts, therefore, must be directed towards the prisoners' moral development too. Moral conduct rises above religion and customs and, therefore, does not influence religious beliefs nor is so influenced by them. Religious beliefs and customs of various segments of the prison population must be respected not only because they constitute a basic right of the individual but also because such respect is psychologically uplifting. Good human conduct would only help in the better tolerance of, and interaction between, different religious sects.

Community participation in as many reform programmes as possible should not only be encouraged but also insisted upon. Communities could participate in programmes relating to prevention of drug abuse, prisoners' education, religious or moral discourses, imparting of technical skills (or providing job work), yoga training, medical assistance or legal assistance. A whole vista of possibilities could be explored in this context. There already existed a healthy infrastructure of community groups, voluntary agencies and non-governmental organizations, which could be approached and which were already working on various such programmes. These agencies would prove invaluable in any such correctional programmes. The community itself would be most helpful in the successful translation of any rehabilitation programme into reality.

* * *

Organized gangs within prisons could prove a great deterrent to any reform programme by acting as pressure groups. It will always be in the interests of these groups to continue a system of destabilization in the prisons. Isolation of hardened criminals from the rest of the prison population